

Algebra and Discrete Mathematics (ADM)

Tutorial 3 Matrix inverse and solving linear systems

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Inverse of 2×2 matrices

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}$$

when

$$\det(A) = ad - bc \neq 0,$$

we have

$$A^{-1} = \frac{1}{\det(A)} \begin{pmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{pmatrix}$$

Inverse of 2×2 matrices

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 2 \\ 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix}$$

The determinant of A is

$$\det(A) = 2 \times (-1) - 1 \times 2 = -4 \neq 0$$

Then

$$A^{-1} = \frac{1}{\det(A)} \begin{pmatrix} -1 & -2 \\ -1 & 2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{4} & \frac{1}{2} \\ \frac{1}{4} & -\frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix}$$

Or by row operations

$$\left(\begin{array}{cc|cc} 2 & 2 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & -1 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right) \xrightarrow{R_1 \rightarrow \frac{1}{2}R_1} \left(\begin{array}{cc|cc} 1 & 1 & \frac{1}{2} & 0 \\ 1 & -1 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right) \xrightarrow{R_2 \rightarrow R_2 - R_1} \left(\begin{array}{cc|cc} 1 & 1 & \frac{1}{2} & 0 \\ 0 & -2 & -\frac{1}{2} & 1 \end{array} \right)$$

Inverse of 2×2 matrices

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 2 \\ 1 & -1 \end{pmatrix}$$

By row operations

$$\left(\begin{array}{cc|cc} 1 & 1 & \frac{1}{2} & 0 \\ 0 & -2 & -\frac{1}{2} & 1 \end{array} \right) \xrightarrow{R_2 \rightarrow -\frac{1}{2}R_2} \left(\begin{array}{cc|cc} 1 & 1 & \frac{1}{2} & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & \frac{1}{4} & -\frac{1}{2} \end{array} \right) \xrightarrow{R_1 \rightarrow R_1 - R_2} \left(\begin{array}{cc|cc} 1 & 0 & \frac{1}{4} & \frac{1}{2} \\ 0 & 1 & \frac{1}{4} & -\frac{1}{2} \end{array} \right)$$

Inverse of 2×2 matrices

For $A \in \mathcal{M}_{2 \times 2}$, when do we have $A^{-1} = A$?

$$\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} = \frac{1}{\det(A)} \begin{pmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{pmatrix}$$

$$a = \frac{d}{\det(A)}, \quad b = -\frac{b}{\det(A)}, \quad c = -\frac{c}{\det(A)}, \quad d = \frac{a}{\det(A)}$$

- If $\det(A) \neq -1$, then $b = c = 0$. Since A is invertible,

$$\det(A) = ad \neq 0.$$

Moreover,

$$a = \frac{d}{ad} = \frac{1}{a}, \quad d = \frac{a}{ad} = \frac{1}{d},$$

so $a^2 = d^2 = 1$. Since $ad = \det(A) \neq -1$, we must have $a = d$. Hence

$$A = I_2 \quad \text{or} \quad A = -I_2.$$

Inverse of 2×2 matrices

For $A \in \mathcal{M}_{2 \times 2}$, when do we have $A^{-1} = A$?

$$\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} = \frac{1}{\det(A)} \begin{pmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{pmatrix}$$

$$a = \frac{d}{\det(A)}, \quad b = -\frac{b}{\det(A)}, \quad c = -\frac{c}{\det(A)}, \quad d = \frac{a}{\det(A)}$$

- If $\det(A) = -1$, then $a = -d$, so

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & -a \end{pmatrix}, \quad a^2 + bc = 1.$$

Inverse of 2×2 matrices

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 4 & 3 \\ -5 & -4 \end{pmatrix}$$

Then

$$A^{-1} = \frac{1}{4 \times (-4) - 3 \times (-5)} \begin{pmatrix} -4 & -3 \\ 5 & 4 \end{pmatrix} = - \begin{pmatrix} -4 & -3 \\ 5 & 4 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 4 & 3 \\ -5 & -4 \end{pmatrix} = A$$

Solve linear system using matrix inverse

$$\begin{aligned} -y + z &= 2 \\ 2x + 3y &= 12 \\ -x - z &= -7 \end{aligned}$$

The system can be presented by $A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}$, where

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1 & 1 \\ 2 & 3 & 0 \\ -1 & 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{x} = \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \\ z \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{b} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 12 \\ -7 \end{pmatrix}$$

Find inverse of A

$$\left(\begin{array}{ccc|ccc} 0 & -1 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 2 & 3 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ -1 & 0 & -1 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right) \xrightarrow{(-R_3) \leftrightarrow R_1} \left(\begin{array}{ccc|ccc} 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & -1 \\ 2 & 3 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \end{array} \right)$$

Solve linear system using matrix inverse

$$\begin{aligned} -y + z &= 2 \\ 2x + 3y &= 12 \\ -x - z &= -7 \end{aligned}$$

Find inverse of A

$$\left(\begin{array}{ccc|ccc} 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & -1 \\ 2 & 3 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \end{array} \right) \xrightarrow{R_2 \rightarrow R_2 - 2R_1} \left(\begin{array}{ccc|ccc} 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & -1 \\ 0 & 3 & -2 & 0 & 1 & 2 \\ 0 & -1 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \end{array} \right) \xrightarrow[R_2 \leftrightarrow (-R_3)]{R_2 \rightarrow R_2 + 3R_3}$$

$$\left(\begin{array}{ccc|ccc} 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & -1 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 & -1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 & 1 & 2 \end{array} \right) \xrightarrow[R_1 \rightarrow R_1 - R_3]{R_2 \rightarrow R_2 + R_3} \left(\begin{array}{ccc|ccc} 1 & 0 & 0 & -3 & -1 & -3 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 2 & 1 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 3 & 1 & 2 \end{array} \right)$$

Solve linear system using matrix inverse

$$-y + z = 2$$

$$2x + 3y = 12$$

$$-x - z = -7$$

$$A^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} -3 & -1 & -3 \\ 2 & 1 & 2 \\ 3 & 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix}$$

The solution is given by

$$\mathbf{x} = A^{-1}\mathbf{b} = \begin{pmatrix} -3 & -1 & -3 \\ 2 & 1 & 2 \\ 3 & 1 & 2 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 12 \\ -7 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 2 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}$$

Solve linear system using matrix inverse

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 2 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 2 & 2 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{b}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 4 \\ -2 \\ 7 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{b}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 8 \\ -7 \\ 8 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 & | & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 2 & 1 & 1 & 1 & | & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 & -1 & | & 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 2 & 2 & 0 & | & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \xrightarrow[\substack{R_3 \rightarrow R_3 - R_1, \quad R_4 \rightarrow R_4 - R_1}]{R_2 \rightarrow R_2 - 2R_1} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 & | & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 & -1 & | & -2 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 & -2 & | & -1 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 & 1 & -1 & | & -1 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$
$$\xrightarrow[\substack{R_4 \rightarrow R_4 - 2R_2}]{R_3 \rightarrow R_3 - R_2} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 & | & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 & -1 & | & -2 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & -1 & | & 1 & -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 3 & 1 & | & 3 & -2 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

Solve linear system using matrix inverse

$$\left(\begin{array}{cccc|cccc} 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 & -1 & -2 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & -1 & 1 & -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 3 & 1 & 3 & -2 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right) \xrightarrow{\frac{1}{3}R_4 \leftrightarrow (-R_3)} \left(\begin{array}{cccc|cccc} 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 & -1 & -2 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & \frac{1}{3} & 1 & -\frac{2}{3} & 0 & \frac{1}{3} \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & -1 & 1 & -1 & 0 \end{array} \right)$$

$$\xrightarrow[\begin{array}{l} R_2 \rightarrow R_2 + R_3 \\ R_1 \rightarrow R_1 - R_3 \end{array}]{\phantom{\frac{1}{3}R_4 \leftrightarrow (-R_3)}} \left(\begin{array}{cccc|cccc} 1 & 0 & 0 & \frac{2}{3} & 0 & \frac{2}{3} & 0 & -\frac{1}{3} \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & -\frac{2}{3} & -1 & \frac{1}{3} & 0 & \frac{1}{3} \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & \frac{1}{3} & 1 & -\frac{2}{3} & 0 & \frac{1}{3} \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & -1 & 1 & -1 & 0 \end{array} \right)$$

Solve linear system using matrix inverse

$$\left(\begin{array}{cccc|cccc} 1 & 0 & 0 & \frac{2}{3} & 0 & \frac{2}{3} & 0 & -\frac{1}{3} \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & -\frac{2}{3} & -1 & \frac{1}{3} & 0 & \frac{1}{3} \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & \frac{1}{3} & 1 & -\frac{2}{3} & 0 & \frac{1}{3} \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & -1 & 1 & -1 & 0 \end{array} \right) \xrightarrow[\substack{R_2 \rightarrow R_2 + \frac{2}{3}R_4, \quad R_3 \rightarrow R_3 - \frac{1}{3}R_4}]{R_1 \rightarrow R_1 - \frac{2}{3}R_4}$$

$$\left(\begin{array}{cccc|cccc} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & \frac{2}{3} & 0 & \frac{2}{3} & -\frac{1}{3} \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & -\frac{5}{3} & 1 & -\frac{2}{3} & \frac{1}{3} \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & \frac{4}{3} & -1 & \frac{1}{3} & \frac{1}{3} \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & -1 & 1 & -1 & 0 \end{array} \right) \Rightarrow A^{-1} = \frac{1}{3} \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 0 & 2 & -1 \\ -5 & 3 & -2 & 1 \\ 4 & -3 & 1 & 1 \\ -3 & 3 & -3 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

Solve linear system using matrix inverse

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 2 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 2 & 2 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{b}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 4 \\ -2 \\ 7 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{b}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 8 \\ -7 \\ 8 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\mathbf{x}_1 = A^{-1}\mathbf{b}_1 = \frac{1}{3} \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 0 & 2 & -1 \\ -5 & 3 & -2 & 1 \\ 4 & -3 & 1 & 1 \\ -3 & 3 & -3 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 4 \\ -2 \\ 7 \end{pmatrix} = \frac{1}{3} \begin{pmatrix} -7 \\ 13 \\ 1 \\ 12 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\mathbf{x}_2 = A^{-1}\mathbf{b}_2 = \frac{1}{3} \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 0 & 2 & -1 \\ -5 & 3 & -2 & 1 \\ 4 & -3 & 1 & 1 \\ -3 & 3 & -3 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 8 \\ -7 \\ 8 \end{pmatrix} = \frac{1}{3} \begin{pmatrix} -14 \\ 26 \\ -7 \\ 33 \end{pmatrix}$$

Solve linear system using matrix inverse

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 2 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 2 & 2 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{b}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 4 \\ -2 \\ 7 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{b}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 8 \\ -7 \\ 8 \end{pmatrix}$$

We can verify that

$$A\mathbf{x}_1 = \frac{1}{3} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 2 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 2 & 2 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} -7 \\ 13 \\ 1 \\ 12 \end{pmatrix} = \mathbf{b}_1$$

$$A\mathbf{x}_2 = \frac{1}{3} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 2 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 2 & 2 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} -14 \\ 26 \\ -7 \\ 33 \end{pmatrix} = \mathbf{b}_2$$

Update to Homework Assessment Criteria

To give you another opportunity to improve your homework marks, the following changes will apply:

- **Resubmission opportunity for T1–T3:** You may revise and resubmit your solutions to Tutorials 1–3.
- **Deadline:** 15 October 2026, 10am
- **Updated marking scheme:** You can earn up to **24 marks** in total across all homework assignments, including **14 extra marks**.

Please use this opportunity to complete missing questions, correct errors, and improve the clarity of your solutions.

Homework Expectations and Resubmission Policy (T4–T12)

- **Make a genuine effort** to solve all required homework questions before each tutorial.
- You are expected to understand the methods and reasoning, not simply copy the provided solutions.
- **Grading criteria:**
 - **2 marks:** All required questions are meaningfully attempted, with correct and sufficiently detailed solutions.
 - **1 mark:** All required questions are meaningfully attempted, but some solutions contain errors or incomplete reasoning.
 - **0 marks:** One or more required questions are not meaningfully attempted.
- **Resubmission opportunity (T4–T12 only):** If you receive **1 mark**, you may revise and resubmit your homework after the tutorial to improve your grade to **2 marks**.
- **Resubmission deadline:** You may resubmit your homework either in person or via UIS. Strictly follow the deadline specified in UIS; **no late submissions will be accepted**.

Quiz one information

- Time: 9:30–11:50
- Location: same room as the lecture
- Toilet breaks are not permitted during the quiz.
- Calculators are not allowed.
- Write your answers on the provided answer sheets. Additional sheets will be supplied upon request.
- Write your full name clearly on every page of your answer sheets.
- Show all computation steps in sufficient detail. Answers without supporting calculations will receive zero points, even if the final answer is correct.

Quiz one information

- Q1: dot product, orthogonality, and vector norm
- Q2: matrix multiplication, transpose, scalar multiplication, and matrix subtraction
- Q3: linear systems, Gauss–Jordan elimination, consistency, and solution sets
- Q4: matrix inversion using row operations, elementary matrices and their inverses, and products of elementary matrices